

MGT407 - Marketing

Fall 2025

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OFFICE HOURS: Before/after class or by appointment

DESCRIPTION

Marketing Management focuses on the strategic and tactical aspects of marketing decision-making in dynamic business environments. Understanding this topic is essential for driving business growth, building strong customer relationships, and staying competitive in a rapidly changing marketplace.

This is a case-based course. Cases, as microcosms, deliver the power of real-world, applied settings and reveal concepts and frameworks that can inform management thoughts and actions. Our collective experience and expertise outweighs and overshadows the knowledge any one faculty member can impart. Case discussions, and the full participation they require, is an integral component of this course.

OBJECTIVES

At the close of Marketing you will be able to:

- Analyze market opportunities to identify customer needs and competitive advantages.
- Develop effective marketing strategies aligned with organizational goals.
- Apply marketing concepts to real-world business scenarios and decision-making processes.
- Evaluate the effectiveness of marketing campaigns and suggest improvements.
- Demonstrate the ability to create integrated marketing plans that deliver customer value.

MATERIALS

Required

- Case and Reading Packet.
- [The Marketing Handbook](#) by Alexander Chernev

Recommended

- Kotler, Philip and Kevin Lane Keller (any year), Marketing Management (Any edition – the latest also have Alex Chernev as an author). Pearson Publishing.

2025 Schedule

Session	Date	Topic(s)	Reading(s)*	Group Check-ins
1	9/30	Marketing Strategic Framework	Framework for Marketing Strategy CASE: Apex Ski Boots	
2	10/7	Understanding the Customer	Know Customer's "Jobs to Be Done" CASE: Aspire Food Group	Select Group Members
3	10/14	Segmenting, Targeting, & Positioning	Malcolm Gladwell: Spaghetti Sauce Customer Segmentation: The Ultimate Guide What you Need to Know about Segmentation CASE: Travelogo	Choose Idea for Marketing Plan
4	10/21	Product Life Cycle and Customer Lifetime Value	Firing the Right Customers is Good Business CASE: Pulse Fitness A Conceptual Introduction to Customer Lifetime Value Why Brands Like Patagonia (Sometimes) Kick Out Their Customers (optional)	Research!
5	10/28	Promotion	Marketing Communications Made to Stick Introduction Made to Stick Video Summary Jonah Berger on Contagious	
6	11/4	Product (Branding)	Brand Portfolio Strategy and Brand Architecture Dove: Evolution of a Brand	Be done with STP
7	11/11	Price	Pricing Strategy (from <i>Total Revenue Management</i>) CASE: Pricing a Drink for Value Creation Behavioral Pricing How Online Shopping Makes Suckers of Us All	
8	11/18	Price	Pricing Strategy (from HBS) CASE: Drinkworks What Can Conjoint Analysis Do for You?	Tactics!
9	11/25	Place	Effectively Marketing To Millennials and Gen-Z Diffusion of Innovation Theory: The Adoption Curve Rogers Five Factors CASE: Apex Ski Boots	Define Performance Metrics
10	12/2	Presentations & Wrap-up	(Paper due on 10/8)	Presentation Slides Marketing Plan

* Readings in *italics* are videos, podcasts. Hyperlinks lead to online readings.

** This class is scheduled for in-person.

ASSIGNMENTS & DELIVERABLES

Grading

The class is made up of both group and individual assignments and exercises. On the grading sheet below, you will see the level of collaboration allowed for each assignment and graded item.

I – Independent, individual work only. No collaboration or consultation allowed.

C – Collaboration with classmates is allowed. However, each student must submit an individual deliverable.

G – Students may work together in groups and turn in one deliverable for the entire group.]

Exams and Deliverables	Points [or percentage]
Participation/Attendance (I) – 10 @ 4 points	40
Quizzes (I, G) - 10 @ 4 points	40
Marketing Plan Presentation (G)	10
Marketing Plan Paper (G)	10
Total	100

Grading is done on the following scale: A [95,100]; A- [90,95); B+ [87,90); B [83,87); B- [80,83); C+ [77,80); C [73,77); C- [70,73); F [0,70)

Class Participation (I)

Class participation is earned by “attending” class by contributing your thoughts and questions to the various discussions in class. In practice, great ideas that are not articulated (or are not articulated in a compelling way) are ignored. Thus, participation is important to your continued professional development. Further, much of the value of an MBA comes from the interchange with classmates who come from various industries and strategic contexts. The benefits that each of you receive from this class will be directly enhanced by the mutual sharing of insights. Thus, throughout the term, I will track the degree to which you contribute to discussion. Please know that quality of contribution (meaningful insights that help us progress in our discussion of the topic) far outweighs quantity.

Weekley Quizzes (G)

You will be asked to recognize, apply, and explore the marketing strategies discussed in the readings and the cases. To solidify the knowledge, you will complete group discussion quizzes that will ask you to do deeper analysis or take managerial stances and think deeper about the readings. These are not meant to explicitly test whether you have read that week’s readings, but to answer the questions fully, understanding the weekly readings is necessary. However, when completing these quizzes, you **should not** use your notes and class materials unless specifically noted. You **should not** use the wider internet unless specifically noted. We want you to learn and be able to apply this knowledge; LLMs already know this stuff. Hopefully, these quizzes will keep you “on task” by solidifying the knowledge and keep you learning and engaged throughout the quarter.

Marketing Plan Presentation and Paper (G)

The marketing plan paper and presentation is a demonstration of the culmination of knowledge and application. See the schedule for due dates. Detailed assignment instructions will be posted in Canvas. You will submit these assignments through Canvas prior to the start of the last class.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind.

The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at: <http://senate.ucsd.edu/Operating-Procedures/Senate-Manual/Appendices/2>

How the Honor Code applies to this course:

Collaboration is a key component of this course. However, there are certain assignments that are to be done independently, with no outside assistance. Any effort to gain an advantage not given to all students is dishonest whether or not the effort is successful. Copying material from case solutions, teaching notes, or other sources online undermines your learning and is inappropriate from an ethical standpoint. Your ability to benefit from the learning exercise and my ability to accurately evaluate your performance depends upon your integrity at these times. The UCSD academic community regards academic dishonesty as an extremely serious matter, with serious consequences that range from probation to expulsion. When in doubt about issues regarding plagiarism, paraphrasing, quoting, or collaboration, please consult with me

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or osd@ucsd.edu

AI POLICY FOR MARKETING MANAGEMENT COURSE (written with the help of ChatGPT)

This policy outlines the appropriate use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools in the Marketing Management course, ensuring that the technology enhances learning while preserving the integrity of individual thought and effort. The policy applies to all enrolled students in the Executive MBA Marketing Management course.

Permitted Use of AI:

- Understanding and Research: Students are permitted to use AI tools to deepen their understanding of course materials and assist with research related to course topics. AI can be utilized to summarize readings, provide explanations of complex concepts, and generate ideas for project brainstorming.
- Explicitly Allowed Assignments: AI may be used in completing assignments only when explicitly stated in the assignment instructions. These will be designed to specifically leverage AI capabilities in a way that enhances the learning objectives of the task.

Prohibited Use of AI:

- General Assignments and Examinations: The use of generative AI is strictly prohibited in the completion of regular assignments and during examinations. Assignments are crafted to assess individual understanding and the ability to apply marketing concepts independently.

- Discussion Contributions: Participation in course discussions, whether online or in-person, must be free of AI assistance. The value of these discussions lies in the personal insights, original thought, and interaction among peers, which AI usage could undermine.

Rationale:

- The educational value of assignments and discussions in this course stems from personal intellectual engagement and the development of individual analytical skills. AI, while beneficial in certain contexts, can shortcut these learning processes and reduce the depth of personal understanding and critical thinking.

Enforcement:

- Students are expected to adhere to this policy as part of their commitment to academic integrity. Violations of the AI usage policy will be subject to review under the standard academic misconduct procedures and could result in disciplinary action.

Support and Clarifications:

- Students are encouraged to seek clarification from the instructor regarding the use of AI tools in specific instances. The instructor is available to provide guidance on how AI can be appropriately integrated into learning activities without compromising educational outcomes.